Wireshark Filter Cheat Sheet

Important: These are Wireshark display filters, entered in the display-filter bar after capture. Replace example IP addresses with addresses from your own lab. A display filter hides packets from the view; it does not remove them from the capture.

Display filter	What it shows	When to use it
ip.addr == 192.168.1.10	Traffic to or from an IPv4 address	Scope an investigation to one endpoint.
ip.src == 192.168.1.10	Packets sent by an IPv4 address	Identify traffic originating from a host.
ip.dst == 192.168.1.20	Packets sent to an IPv4 address	Inspect traffic targeting a server.
tcp	All TCP packets	Review connection-oriented traffic.
udp	All UDP packets	Review DNS, DHCP and other UDP traffic.
dns	DNS protocol packets	Investigate lookups, unusual domains and repeated queries.
http	Decoded HTTP packets	Inspect methods, hosts, URIs and cleartext headers.
tls	TLS protocol packets	Review handshake metadata, certificates and encrypted sessions.
arp	ARP packets	Investigate IP-to-MAC resolution and possible spoofing.
icmp	ICMP packets	Review ping activity and network diagnostics.
smb || smb2	SMB/SMB2 traffic	Investigate file sharing and possible lateral movement.
tcp.flags.syn == 1 && tcp.flags.ack == 0	Initial TCP SYN packets without ACK	Spot connection attempts and possible SYN scans.
tcp.flags.reset == 1	TCP packets with RST set	Find refused or abruptly reset connections.
tcp.flags.fin == 1	TCP packets with FIN set	Review orderly TCP teardown.
tcp.port == 80	TCP traffic on port 80	Focus on conventional HTTP.
tcp.port == 443	TCP traffic on port 443	Focus on conventional HTTPS/TLS.
udp.port == 53 || tcp.port == 53	DNS traffic on port 53	Inspect standard DNS exchanges over UDP or TCP.
tcp.analysis.retransmission	TCP retransmissions identified by Wireshark	Troubleshoot packet loss, congestion or unusual retries.
tcp.stream == 0	Packets in TCP stream 0	Isolate a conversation; stream number depends on the capture.
frame contains "password"	Frames containing the byte sequence for password	Search visible packet bytes; encoding and encryption can limit results.

❖ **Capture filter vs display filter**

- **Capture filter:** set before/during capture; uses libpcap/BPF syntax and controls which packets are saved.
  Example: host 192.168.1.10 or port 53.

- **Display filter:** applied to packets already captured; uses Wireshark syntax.
  Example: ip.addr == 192.168.1.10 or dns.

❖ **Quick investigation tips**

- Right-click a packet and choose Follow → TCP Stream to inspect a conversation.
- A SYN burst can be legitimate monitoring or an authorized scan; validate source, target, timing, and scope before concluding it is malicious.
- HTTPS payload is encrypted in normal captures; you can often still inspect handshake metadata, certificates, endpoints, and timing.
- The frame contains filter searches packet bytes and can miss text represented in a different encoding or encrypted payload.